



Set the same initial and maximum Virtual Memory size for better performance

memory-intensive games and applications. Make sure the initial and maximum sizes are the same—if Windows has to increase the paging file size, the performance gain is lost. For more information on Virtual Memory, visit <http://aumha.org/win5/a/xpvm.php>.

Fine tuning

Go to **Start > Run**, type '**msconfig**' and press [Enter] to open the System Configuration Utility. In the Start Up tab, uncheck programs that you don't want to load at start up. If you're not sure about an entry, leave it unchanged. Finally, click OK and restart your PC. Now, go to **Start > Run**, type '**gpedit.msc**' and press [Enter] to open Group Policy Editor. This is applicable only for Windows XP Professional. Enable the following policies:

User Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Explorer > Remove CD Burning Features
User Configuration > Adminis-

trative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Explorer > Remove Shared Documents from My Computer

Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > System > Remove boot / Shutdown / Logon / Logoff messages

User Configuration > Administrative Templates > Start Menu and Taskbar > Turn off user tracking

Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > System > Turn off Autoplay

Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Internet Explorer > Disable Showing the Splash Screen

Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Messenger (Enable both items)

User configuration > Administrative Templates > Desktop > Remove My Documents icon from Desktop

Tuning the registry

Though editing the registry can give you power, it can damage your operating system as well. Always backup up your registry before editing it. Once you've taken a backup, open the registry editor—go to **Start > Run**, type '**regedit**' and press [Enter]. To improve the shutdown and restart process, navigate to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop**, and edit the following entries:

'HungAppTimeout=4000',
'WaitToKillAppTimeout=4000',
'MenuShowDelay=20' and

'AutoEndTasks=1'. Here, 1000 means 1 second.

Now, navigate to **'HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Session Manager\Memory Management\PrefetchParameters'** and change the value of 'EnablePrefetcher' to 5.

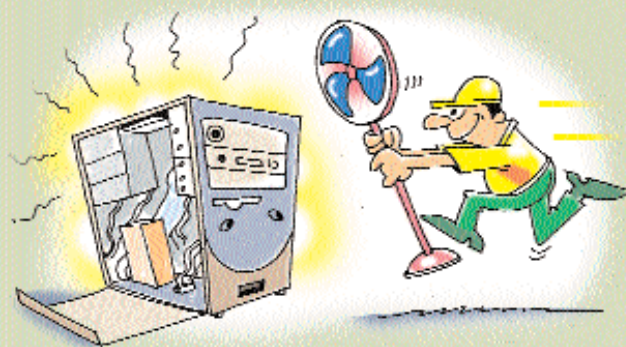
To remove the Outlook Express splash screen, go to **'HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Identities\{Unique Identity}\Software\Microsoft\Outlook Express\5.0'**, create a new DWORD value named 'NoSplash' and set its value to 1.

To disable Balloon tips, go to **'HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer**

Advanced', and create a DWORD value named 'EnableBalloonTips' and set it to 0.

To turn off the 'low disk space' notification, go to **'HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\lanmanserver'** and create a DWORD value named 'DiskSpaceThreshold' and set its value to between 0 and 99. This will denote the threshold free space in percentage, before the notification pops up. This is especially helpful when you have a partition that is almost full, but don't want to delete anything from it such as a swap partition with a fixed swap file.

UNDER THE HOOD



BIOS tweaks

On POST, press [Delete]—or [F2], depending on your BIOS—to enter the BIOS Setup utility. You can also use utilities such as TweakBIOS for this. Customise the following settings:

Disable 'Boot Up Floppy Seek'. Most newer systems don't require this.

Set the Boot Sequence to boot from the drive where Windows is installed.

Disable 'Video BIOS Shadow'.

Enable Shadow System BIOS—see if it increases performance for your system, otherwise disable it.

Disable 'Video BIOS Cacheable'—most new video



ZDNet India
Where Technology takes you

Virus Alerts, Bug Fixes, Patches, Security

Virus Workshop

www.zdnetindia.com/virus